

Absolutely — **flower** is a nice target because your passage most naturally uses it to mean **flowering plants grown in pots**, while the bare noun can also refer specifically to the **blossom itself**. The wider family then develops useful botanical, figurative, design, and occupational meanings.

Word family: **flower / flowering / floral / florist / floristry**

Base word: flower

Plural: flowers

Verb forms: flower, flowers, flowered, flowering

Related forms: flowering, floral, florist, floristry

Useful compounds / extensions: flowerpot, flowerbed, flower arrangement, flowering plant, in flower

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related and noun-related forms (相關形容詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “I remember seeing little pots of herbs and **flowers** near her windows...”

Meaning in your passage: **flowers = flowering plants — 花卉；開花植物**

In this sentence, **flowers** most naturally refers to:

> **small flowering plants being grown in pots**, not merely detached blossoms.

繁體中文：

種在花盆裡、會開花並以花朵作為主要觀賞部分的植物；花卉

Natural translation:

> “I remember seeing little pots of herbs and flowers near her windows.”

「我記得她家窗邊放著一些小盆栽、香草和**花卉 / 開花植物**。」

So here:

> **flowers = 種植來觀賞花朵的植物**

1. **flower = blossom on a plant (植物的花朵) — 花；花朵**

The basic literal sense.

Practice 1

> “The plant has small white **flowers**.”

「這棵植物開著小小的白色**花朵**。」

Practice 2

> “She picked a **flower** from the garden.”

「她從花園裡摘了一**朵花**。」

flower = 植物用來繁殖、通常具有花瓣並具有觀賞性的花朵部分

This refers specifically to the **blossom**, not the entire plant.

2. **flower** = flowering plant (植物本身) — 花卉；開花植物

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 3 — Original

> “I remember seeing little pots of herbs and **flowers** near her windows.”

「我記得她窗邊放著一些香草和**花卉盆栽**。」

Practice 4

> “She grows vegetables as well as **flowers**.”

「她除了種蔬菜，也種**花卉 / 開花植物**。」

Practice 5

> “These flowers need plenty of sunlight.”

「這些**花卉植物**需要充足陽光。」

flower — plant = 主要因花朵而被種植、觀賞的開花植物

This distinction is useful:

> **a flower** can mean one blossom

> **flowers** can also mean flowering plants collectively

3. **flower** = produce flowers (動詞 ; 植物) — **開花**

Now **flower** is a verb.

Practice 6

> “The roses **flower** in early summer.”

「玫瑰在初夏**開花**。」

Practice 7

> “This plant may not **flower** until next year.”

「這棵植物可能要到明年才會**開花**。」

flower — verb = 植物長出並開放花朵

4. **be in flower** (植物狀態) — 正在開花 ; 花期中

A useful botanical expression.

Practice 8

> “The jasmine is **in flower** now.”

「茉莉現在正**在開花 / 處於花期**。」

Practice 9

> “The garden looks beautiful when the roses are in flower.”

「玫瑰**盛開時**，花園看起來很漂亮。」

in flower = 植物目前正在開花、處於花期

5. **flower** = develop / flourish fully (比喻) — 發展 ; 成熟 ; 蓬勃成長

A genuinely important figurative verb meaning.

Practice 10

> “Her interest in gardening **flowered** into a lifelong passion.”

「她對園藝的興趣後來**發展成**一生的熱愛。」

Practice 11

> “His talent began to **flower** when he reached university.”

「他的才華到了大學時期開始**充分發展 / 綻放**。」

flower — figurative = 某種能力、關係、文化或興趣逐漸發展成熟並達到較完整、繁盛的狀態

The metaphor is:

> bud → bloom

> early potential → full development

6. **flowering** = producing flowers (植物) — 開花的；正在開花的

Practice 12

> “She keeps several **flowering plants** on the balcony.”

「她在露台放了幾盆**開花植物**。」

Practice 13

> “The **flowering trees** attract many bees.”

「那些**開花的樹木**吸引了很多蜜蜂。」

flowering = 正在產生花朵，或屬於能開花的植物

7. **flowering plant** (植物學) — 開花植物；被子植物

A common scientific/botanical compound.

Practice 14

> “Most garden plants are **flowering plants**.”

「大部分園藝植物都是**開花植物**。」

Practice 15

> “Flowering plants reproduce by producing flowers and seeds.”

「**開花植物**透過產生花朵和種子繁殖。」

flowering plant = 會產生花朵並形成種子的植物類群

In more technical botany:

> **angiosperms** = 被子植物

8. **flowering** = flourishing/development (比喻名詞) — 繁榮；蓬勃發展

A useful academic/art-history extension.

Practice 16

> “The period saw a **flowering of art and literature**.”

「那個時期出現了藝術和文學的**蓬勃發展 / 繁榮**。」

Practice 17

> “The city experienced a flowering of new ideas.”

「這座城市經歷了一段新思想**蓬勃湧現的時期**。」

flowering — figurative noun = 某種文化、藝術、思想或活動快速發展並達到繁盛狀態

9. **the flower of + group/generation** (最優秀者；較文學) — 精英；精華

A genuine but more literary use.

Practice 18

> “The school attracted the **flower of the region’s young talent**.”

「這間學校吸引了區內年輕人才中的**精英 / 佼佼者**。」

Practice 19

> “The poem describes them as the flower of their generation.”

「詩中把他們形容為那一代人的**精華 / 最優秀人物**。」

****the flower of something = 某群體中最出色、最優秀或最具代表性的一批人 / 事物****

Register: literary/formal.

I would include it, but clearly below the everyday senses.

10. ****floral = relating to flowers (花的) — 花卉的；與花有關的****

Practice 20

> “The room had a fresh ****floral scent****.”

「房間裡有清新的****花香****。」

Practice 21

> “She chose a floral design for the curtains.”

「她為窗簾選了一個****花卉圖案****。」

****floral = 與花朵、花香或花卉圖案有關的****

Common:

- * floral scent
- * floral pattern
- * floral design
- * floral arrangement

11. ****floral = having a flower-like scent/flavour (香氣 / 味道) — 帶花香的****

A common food/perfume/wine use.

Practice 22

> “The tea has a light **floral aroma**.”

「這種茶帶有淡淡的**花香**。」

Practice 23

> “The perfume has soft floral notes.”

「這款香水帶有柔和的**花香調**。」

****floral — scent/flavour = 香氣或味道帶有類似花朵的特徵****

This is a contextual branch of the broader ****floral**** sense.

12. ****florist = person/shop selling and arranging flowers — 花店；花藝師****

Practice 24

> “She bought the roses from a local ****florist****.”

「她在本地****花店****買了玫瑰。」

Practice 25

> “The florist prepared the wedding flowers.”

「****花藝師****準備了婚禮用花。」

****florist = 售賣花卉、製作花束或花藝作品的人；亦可指花店****

Important contextual shift:

* a florist = 花藝師 / 花商

* the florist's / florist shop = 花店

13. ****floristry = business/art of arranging and selling flowers — 花藝；花卉業****

Practice 26

> “She studied ****floristry**** after leaving school.”

「她畢業後學習**花藝**。」

Practice 27

> “Floristry combines design skills with knowledge of plants.”

「**花藝**結合設計技巧和植物知識。」

floristry = 設計、整理、展示及出售花卉的專業 / 藝術

14. **flowerpot = container for growing flowers/plants — 花盆**

You have just curated **pot**, so this is a useful family cross-link rather than a new meaning of **flower**.

Practice 28

> “The old **flowerpot** cracked in the cold weather.”

「舊**花盆**在寒冷天氣下裂開了。」

Practice 29

> “She placed the flowerpots along the balcony.”

「她把**花盆**沿著露台擺放。」

flowerpot = 用來種植花卉 / 其他植物的容器

15. **flowerbed = area of soil planted with flowers — 花壇**

Practice 30

> “She planted roses in the **flowerbed**.”

「她在**花壇**裡種了玫瑰。」

Practice 31

> “The flowerbeds are full of colour in spring.”

「春天時，**花壇**色彩繽紛。」

****flowerbed = 專門用來種植花卉的一塊整理過的土地****

16. ****flower arrangement (花藝) — 插花；花藝作品****

Practice 32

> “The table was decorated with a beautiful ****flower arrangement****.”

「桌上擺放了一件漂亮的****插花 / 花藝作品****。」

Practice 33

> “She learned how to make flower arrangements.”

「她學會了怎樣製作****插花作品****。」

****flower arrangement = 把花朵和植物材料按照美感設計排列而成的裝飾作品****

Important distinction: ****flower vs plant****

****plant****

very broad:
any plant organism.

****flower****

can mean:

1. the blossom;
2. a plant grown mainly for its blossoms.

So:

> a tomato plant
> = 番茄植物

but we do not normally call it:

> a flower

even though it produces flowers.

Important distinction: **flower vs blossom**

These overlap strongly.

flower

general word for the reproductive bloom.

blossom

especially common for flowers on:

- * fruit trees;
- * shrubs;
- * trees generally.

> cherry blossom

> = 櫻花

> apple blossom

> = 蘋果花

Blossom can also function as a verb meaning flower/develop.

Important distinction: **flower vs bloom**

flower

noun:

the individual flower.

bloom

can mean:

- * a flower;
- * the state/process of flowering.

> “The roses are in bloom.”

= 玫瑰正在盛開。

****Bloom**** often emphasizes the flowering state more than the botanical object itself.

Important distinction: ****flower vs floral****

****flower****

noun/verb:

- > flower garden
- > the roses flower

****floral****

adjective:

- > floral scent
- > floral pattern

So:

- > ****flower smell**** is possible in some contexts,

but:

- > ****floral scent****

is the standard adjective phrase for 「花香」.

Important distinction: ****flower vs flowering plant****

A flowering plant is not necessarily what everyday English calls ****a flower****.

For example:

- > a tomato plant

is botanically a ****flowering plant****, because it produces flowers.

But in everyday English it is not normally called:

> “a flower.”

So:

****flowering plant = botanical category****

****flower = everyday ornamental flowering plant / blossom****

Important distinction: ****flower vs flowerpot****

****flower****

= plant/blossom

****flowerpot****

= container

Your source has:

> ****pots of flowers****

= 花盆裡種著花

not:

> the pots themselves being flowers.

Important distinction: ****flower vs greenery****

You curated ****greenery**** under ****green****.

****flowers****

emphasizes visible blooms.

****greenery****

emphasizes leaves/plants/green foliage generally.

A room can contain a lot of ****greenery**** without having any visible ****flowers****.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **flower — blossom** = 花朵
- * **flower — flowering plant** = 花卉 / 開花植物
- * **flower — verb** = 開花
- * **in flower** = 正在開花 / 花期中
- * **flower — figurative development** = 發展成熟 / 蓬勃成長
- * **flowering — botanical** = 開花的
- * **flowering plant** = 開花植物 / 被子植物
- * **flowering — figurative** = 蓬勃發展 / 繁榮
- * **the flower of... ** = 某群體中的精英 / 精華
- * **floral** = 花卉相關的 / 花香的
- * **florist** = 花藝師 / 花店
- * **floristry** = 花藝 / 花卉業
- * **flowerpot** = 花盆
- * **flowerbed** = 花壇
- * **flower arrangement** = 插花 / 花藝作品

I would stop there rather than flood the entry with every transparent plant compound such as *sunflower, wildflower,* or *passionflower*. Those are individual plant names rather than useful new meanings of **flower**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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flower — blossom	植物用來繁殖、通常具有花瓣的花朵部分
flower — flowering plant	主要因花朵而被種植或觀賞的開花植物 / 花卉
flower — verb	植物長出並開放花朵
in flower	植物目前正在開花、處於花期
flower — figurative	某種能力、興趣、文化或關係逐漸發展成熟並變得繁盛
flowering — botanical	正在產生花朵或屬於會開花植物的
flowering plant	會產生花朵並形成種子的植物類群
flowering — figurative noun	文化、藝術、思想等快速發展並達到繁盛的狀態
**the flower of... **	某群體中最優秀、最出色的一批人 / 事物
floral	與花朵、花香或花卉圖案有關的
florist	售賣 / 整理花卉的花藝師；亦可指花店
floristry	設計、整理、展示和出售花卉的專業 / 藝術
flowerpot	用來種植花卉 / 植物的花盆
flowerbed	專門整理來種植花卉的一塊土地 / 花壇

| **flower arrangement** | 把花朵和植物材料按美感排列而成的插花 / 花藝作品 |

For your original sentence

> “I remember seeing little pots of herbs and **flowers** near her windows...”

The exact meaning is:

flowers = 種在小花盆裡、以花朵作為主要觀賞部分的花卉植物

So naturally:

> **“little pots of herbs and flowers”**

= **「幾盆香草和花卉 / 小盆栽」**

The particularly useful distinction is:

> **a flower** → 一朵花

> **flowers in pots** → 種在盆裡的花卉植物

> **the plant flowers** → 植物開花

> **floral** → 花卉 / 花香相關的

> **florist** → 花藝師 / 花店

> **flowering** → 開花的，或比喻蓬勃發展的